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2026 NBA Draft turns out to be one of wildest ever P.4

DALAWANG ONLINE SELLER NG ILEGAL NA VAPE PRODUCTS, TIMBOG SA BUY-BUST OPERATION NG MARITIME POLICE SA BATANGAS

NI: MARTIN BANAAG



Timbog ang dalawang lalaki matapos mahuli sa aktong pagbeben-ta ng mga ilegal at un-

taxed na vape products sa isinagawang buy-bust operation ng Batangas Maritime Police Sta-

tion sa Brgy. Manghi-nao, Bauan, Batangas noong Hunyo 12.2026 Kinilala ang dalawang

Suspek na sina alyas Carl at Jhul na kapwa residente ng Batangas City. Nahuli ang dalawa

matapos magbenta ng vape products sa isang poseur-buyer na isinaga-wa ng mga operatiba ng

Batangas MARPSTA sa pangunguna ni PMAJ Mirasol A. Manalo. ➡(Sundan sa pahina 2)

Zéla

BINI, Kris Lawrence, Juan Karlos, Vice Ganda , Jos Garcia,, Nolo Lopez, Zela, Bilib wagi sa partial list of winners ng 17th Star Awards for Music!

(Sundan sa pahina 2)

ESWF Unveils ENTER BATTLE ZONE 2026 to Strengthen Philippine Esports Pipeline

MANILA, Philippines — The E-Sports World Federation (ESWF) has officially launched ENTER

BATTLE ZONE (EBZ) 2026, a nationwide Mobile Legends: Bang Bang ➡ (TURN TO PAGE 3)

**DALAWANG ONLINE
SELLER NG ILEGAL NA
VAPE PRODUCTS...**
Mula pahina 1



Nakumpiska mula sa mga suspek ang 23 kahon ng disposable vape, 23 kahon ng vape batteries, isang cellular phone na ginagamit umano sa online transactions, at buy-bust money. Nahaharap ang mga suspek sa kasong paglabag sa Sections 254 at 263 ng RA 8424 o TRAIN Law kaugnay ng Section 6 ng RA 10175 o

Cybercrime Prevention Act dahil sa umano'y pagbebenta ng mga untaxed vape products gamit ang online platforms. Patuloy naman pinaigting ng Maritime Group ang kampanya laban sa smuggling at ilegal na bentahan ng mga produktong hindi nagbayad ng tamang buwis. Siyang nakakasira sa ekonomiya ng ating bansa

**BINI, Kris Lawrence, Juan Karlos,
Vice Ganda , Jos Garcia,, Nolo Lopez,
Zela, Bilib... Mula pahina 1**



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INILABAS NA NG PMPC Star Awards Inc. ang partial list of winners para sa parating na 17th Star Awards for Music. Ang mga nanalo sa natitira pang mga kategorya ay iaanunsiyo sa mismong awards night na gaganapin sa Hunyo 25 sa Teatro Greenhills, San Juan City. Pasok sa listahan ng mga nanalo ang tinaguriang Nation's Girl Group, ang BINI, na nagwagi sa Dance Recording of the Year para sa kanilang hit song na "Salamín Salamin." Kasama nilang nanalo sa parehong kategorya ang rising P-Pop boy group na Bilib para sa kanilang dance hit na "Say Whatcha Wanna Say." Kaabang-abang din kung madadagdagan pa ang panalo ng BINI, na nominado rin sa Song of the Year ("Salamín Salamin"), Album of the Year ("Talaarawan"), Duo/Group Artist of the Year, Music Video of the Year, at Pop Album of the Year. Iluwí naman ni Juan Karlos ang tropeyo para sa Male Acoustic Artist of the Year para sa awitin niyang "Tanga Mo Juan." Hihintayin pa ni JK sa awards night kung mananalo rin siya sa iba pang kategoryang nominado siya kabilang na ang Male Recording Artist of the Year, Concert of the Year, at Male Concert Performer. Makulay naman ang panalo ni Unkabogable Superstar Vice Ganda sa Christmas Song of the Year para sa kanyang awiting "Rainbow Christmas." Samantala, excited naman ang mga young stars na sina Jayda Avanzado, Dylan Menor, Jarren Garcia, at Marthena Jickain dahil first time nilang mag-

ho-host ng Star Awards. Bagay silang hosts ng Star Awards for Music dahil pawang mga mang-aawit din naman sila. Bukod sa pagho-host, magpe-perform din si Jarren kasama si Sam Concepcion sa opening number. Pangungunahan nina Ima Castro, JV Decena, at Chad Borja ang tribute number para sa Pilita Corrales Lifetime Achievement Awardee na si Celeste Legaspi at Parangal Levi Celerio Lifetime Achievement Awardee na si Mon del Rosario. Ang rap group na Salbakuta naman ang maghahandog ng tribute number para sa isa pang Pilita Corrales Lifetime Achievement Awardee na si Andrew E. Magkakaroon ng special number ang Rainmakers, na pararangalan din sa awards night bilang Mga Natatanging Alagad ng Musikang Pilipino. Nagdiriwang ang Rainmakers ng kanilang ika-50 anibersaryo sa music industry. May spot number din ang tinaguriang The Revival King na si Jojo Mendrez. Espesyal na pagtatanghal ni Moira dela Torre ang aabangan sa finale. Magbibigay naman ng special Fan Favorite Awards ang PlayTime, na co-presenter ng music event na ito. Bisitahin lang ang kanilang official website - playtime.ph - para makaboto. Itsek din ang social media accounts ng PlayTime para sa iba pang detalye. Makakatuwang ng PMPC Star Awards Inc. sa pag-organisa ng 17th Star Awards for Music ang Echo Jham Entertainment Production na pinamumunuan ni Ms. Mhae Sarenas. Si Calvin Murphy Neria ang magdidi-

rek ng naturang awards night. Sa pangunguna ng kasalukuyang Pangulo ng PMPC Star Awards Inc. na si Fernan de Guzman at ng Overall Chairman ng 17th Star Awards for Music na si Mell Navarro, kasama ang mga opisyal at miyembro ng grupo, sinisigurado nilang magiging bongga at maningning ang parating na awards night sa tulong ng Echo Jham. Samantala, narito ang partial list of winners sa 17th Star Awards for Music:

• Sponge Cola – "Tatlong Buwan" (Independent)
FEMALE R&B ARTIST OF THE YEAR
• Zéla – "Pogi Boy" (AQ Prime Music)
MALE R&B ARTIST OF THE YEAR
• Kris Lawrence – "Within" (Vehnee Saturno Music)
FEMALE ACOUSTIC ARTIST OF THE YEAR
• Angela Ken – "Kulimlim" (Tarsier Records)
MALE ACOUSTIC ARTIST OF THE YEAR
• Juan Karlos – "Tanga Mo Juan" (Sony Music Phils.)
COLLABORATION OF THE YEAR
• "Hanggang Dulo" – Jos Garcia x Nolo Lopez (Stardom Music Production); and "Palagi" – TJ Monterde x KZ Tandingan (Independent)
RAP ALBUM OF THE YEAR
• "Drugs" – Shanti Dope (Universal Records)
RAP ARTIST OF THE YEAR
• Illest Morena – "Morenita" (Independent / TMP Industries)
NEW FEMALE GROUP ART-

IST OF THE YEAR
• PIX!E – "Iced Coffee" (Viva Records)
NEW MALE GROUP ARTIST OF THE YEAR
• Five Fingers – "Lakas Mo" (Star Music / DNA Music PH)
DANCE RECORDING OF THE YEAR
"Say Whatcha Wanna Say" – Bilib (AQ Prime Music); and "Salamín Salamin" – BINI (Star Music)
REVIVAL RECORDING OF THE YEAR
• "Ipagpatawad Mo" – Khel Pangilinan (M Music Live)
INSPIRATIONAL SONG OF THE YEAR
"Pagmamahal sa Tinubuang Lupa" – Kayla Acosta, Kamilla Acosta, Enoch Casiño, Emilio David, Ephraim Maglaque (Independent) Composer: Atty. Persida V. Rueda-Acosta; and "Ningas Ng Pag-asa" -Jamie Rivera Feat. 92 AD (Star Music)
CHRISTMAS SONG OF THE YEAR
"Rainbow Christmas" – Vice Ganda (Star Music)
Composer: Vice Ganda, Jonathan Manalo, Roque "Rox" Santos, Jeremy Glinoga
SPECIAL AWARDS
PILITA CORRALES LIFETIME ACHIEVEMENT AWARDS
Celeste Legaspi
Andrew E.
PARANGAL LEVI CELERIO LIFETIME ACHIEVEMENT AWARD
Mon del Rosario
MGA NATATANGING ALAGAD NG MUSIKANG PILIPINO
Rainmakers

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DOLE IDENTIFIES POVERTY AS LEADING CAUSE OF CHILD LABOR IN CALABARZON



CALAMBA CITY, LAGUNA (PIA) — Poverty remains the leading cause of child labor in CALABARZON and across the country, according to the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) IV-A, as it renewed its call for stronger interventions during the observance of the World Day Against Child Labour.

During the Sulong Southern Tagalog program of the Philippine Information Agency and Radyo Pilipinas, DOLE IV-A Senior Labor and Employment Officer Raymond Ramos highlighted the correlation of poverty and child labor, stressing that efforts to eliminate child labor come from addressing vital economic challenges faced by vulnerable families.

“Kung saan may kahirapan, may child labor, at kung saan may child labor, may kahirapan,” Ramos said, emphasizing how economic hardship often pushes children into work at the expense of their education, development, and well-being.

Despite ongoing interventions, Ramos noted that child labor remains a concern in the region. To address the issue, DOLE continues to conduct profiling and monitoring activities to identify children engaged in child labor and connect them with appropriate assistance and support services.

The agency noted that while child labor cases still exist, sustained interventions from government and partner organizations have helped reduce the number of affected children.

Interventions implemented by DOLE include livelihood assistance for parents and families, medical and dental services, mini job fairs, advocacy seminars, and skills demonstrations conducted in partnership with the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA) and other government agencies.

Ramos said these initiatives aim to provide families with alternative sources of income, improve access to essential services, and equip communities with knowledge to help prevent child labor.

The discussion

formed part of the observance of the World Day Against Child Labour, which carries the international theme, “Red Card to Child Labour: Fair Play for Children, Decent Work for Adults,” led by the International Labour Organization (ILO). In the Philippines, the campaign was localized through the theme, “Ikaw, Ako, Tayo: Sama-samang Pagkilos para sa Batang Malaya.”

The observance reflects the call of DOLE Secretary Francis Tolentino to government agencies, communities, and stakeholders to work together in ending child labor and protecting the rights and welfare of children.

Ramos then clarified that not all forms of work involving children are considered child labor. While children may perform light and age-appropriate tasks that help teach responsibility, child labor refers to work that is hazardous or negatively affects a child’s education, health, growth, and overall development.

Among the worst forms of child labor identified by the Labor department are prostitution, involvement in illegal gambling activities, and hazardous occupations such as mining, charcoal production, and deep-sea fishing. Meanwhile, the agency recognized the challenge of addressing child labor practices that may be linked to cultural traditions, particularly in some indigenous communities.

While respecting cultural practices, DOLE emphasized that the welfare and best interests of children must remain the top priority.

“Kinikilala natin ang kanilang kultura ngunit ang pinakamahaling ay maibigay natin ang tamang pangangalaga sa mga kabataan sapagkat sila ang magmamana ng ating hinaharap,” Ramos said.

DOLE-4A encouraged the public to support initiatives that protect children from exploitation and ensure that they are able to enjoy their right to education, development, and a safe environment.

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ESWF Unveils ENTER BATTLE ZONE 2026...
From page 1

tournament designed to identify and develop emerging Filipino esports players while expanding opportunities for competitive growth and international exposure. The tournament will take place on July 31 to August 2, 2026, bringing together teams from across the country in a structured competitive environment that offers cash prizes, official ESWF rankings, and access to talent development pathways within the federation’s esports ecosystem.

ESWF Chairman Engr. Reynaldo Sanchez leads the initiative, emphasizing the organization’s goal of strengthening esports as a professional development platform for Filipino youth. The program is designed to provide players with opportunities to build competitive experience, improve their skills, and progress toward higher-level tournaments.

The event is supported by ESWF President Arnel Gutierrez and Executive Vice President Henry V. Bayubay. The federation underscores its broader commitment to building a sustainable esports structure that promotes discipline, teamwork, sportsmanship, and digital innovation.

A key feature of the tournament is the EBZ Rating System, an official ESWF ranking framework that tracks team

and player performance. The system is intended to establish competitive credibility, increase visibility for standout players, and support talent identification for future regional and international competitions.

Top-performing teams will receive cash prizes and additional recognition. The champion will receive ₱50,000, followed by ₱25,000 for second place and ₱15,000 for third place. ESWF will also recognize the Top 10 finishing teams with special rewards that may include gaming gear, sponsor giveaways, merchandise, certificates, and opportunities for further exposure within ESWF programs.

Registration is open to Mobile Legends teams, schools, universities, esports clubs, barangays, youth organizations, and gaming communities nationwide. The deadline for registration is July 24, 2026.

Following ENTER BATTLE ZONE 2026, ESWF will hold SALPAKAN: Games of the General 2026 from August 5 to 8 at the SMX Convention Center in Pasay City, featuring gaming competitions and interactive esports activities.

For registration and event details, participants may access the official tournament portal at <https://mobaezb.bb88advertising.com>



SHOWBLITZ
By: Charlene Mae

Barbie nag-enjoy sa damit pangkasal, David naghahanda na sa future!



Pinag-usapan ang post ni Barbie Forteza na nakasuot pangkasal at handa nang lumakad papunta sa altar.

Ito ay kahit alam ng lahat na single siya at para ito sa project nila ni Sharon Cuneta.

“I’ve waited for this for so long. Nobody can ruin my big day,” sabi ni Barbie sa caption.

Pero kung si Barbie ay single, si David Licauco naman ay naghahanda na sa kanyang future kaya’t tuloy ang pagpupursigi niya sa trabaho.

Maraming nag-manifest noon na magkatotoo ang BarDa loveteam nina Barbie at David, pero hindi nangyari.

Sa ngayon nga ay aminado si David na naghahanda na siya sa kanyang future.

“I think I’m preparing lang for my future, ‘di ba? I think ever since naman open naman ako sa goal ko na for my future family to have a good life, ‘di ba? So siyempre, lahat nang aspeto ng buhay ko medyo planado naman na talaga, eh. Alam ko na gagawin ko this year, gagawin ko next year. Pero siyempre if may mga ibang opportunities, willing naman ako to adjust. Pero as of now, alam ko anong gagawin ko in the next five years, and adjust na lang accordingly,” sabi niya sa Bluewater Day Spa Summer Unwind launch last week.

At kahit busy sa rami ng trabaho at mga negosyo, sinabin rin ang aktor na may oras pa rin naman siya sa pakikipag-date. Pero mas gusto raw talaga niyang gawing pribado ang lovelife niya.

At nang hingan siya ng comment tungkol sa sightings sa kanila ng rumored non-showbiz GF niyang si Alex Manalang, hindi raw siya aware rito. “Ah, meron ba? Ah, talaga? Baka hindi ako ‘yon,” sagot niya na pag-iwas sa mga tanong.

Wala raw siyang masyadong mainaku-comment dahil mas gusto nga niyang mag-ing private ang usaping ito. “Always naman private, always naman ako private,” diin pa ng aktor/negosyante.

Idinepena naman ni David ang isyung nag-iisnaban sila ni Barbie particular na raw sa opening ng franchise ni Alden Richards ng isang fast food chain. “Nagpansinan naman kami. I think ano lang, nahiya lang ako kasi late ako nu’n, eh,” dagdag niya. Basta, happy raw siya sa kasalukuyan. “Happy ako sa lahat... na hindi na ‘ko masyadong nag-o-overthink. Mas relaxed ako sa life ko ngayon, stable. Yes, balanced, sa personal life and showbiz, pati sa business. Parang I’m not chasing anything. I know who I am,” katuwiran niya.

SPORTS NEWS

2026 NBA Draft turns out to be one of wildest ever

NEW YORK — Every NBA Draft promises hope. The 2026 edition delivered something more: surprises, history, and a glimpse into where basketball’s future is headed.

By the time the first round ended Tuesday night (Wednesday in Manila) at Barclays Center in Brooklyn, a Mexican trail-blazer had made history; one of the most anticipated No. 1 pick debates in years had finally been settled; the Memphis Grizzlies had assembled one of the league’s most intriguing young cores; and New York’s two franchises had taken dramatically different paths.

The result was one of the wildest draft nights in recent memory. Dybantsa wins race for No. 1.

For months, basketball executives debated whether BYU star AJ Dybantsa or Kansas standout Darryn Peterson deserved to be selected first overall. Washington made its choice. The Wizards selected Dybantsa with the top pick, making him the first player in BYU history to be chosen No. 1 overall. The 6-foot-9 wing capped a remarkable freshman season in which he scored 894 points, the third-most ever by a Division I freshman. “It meant a lot to me,” Dybantsa said after hearing his name called. “I definitely wanted to be a staple as the No. 1 pick and be in the same conversation with LeBron James and Cooper Flagg and Allen Iverson.”

Peterson, who many scouts viewed as an equally worthy candidate, went second to Utah.

The disappointment was evident, but so was the motivation. “I wanted to be the No. 1 pick,” Peterson admitted. “Now it will always be in my mind for my whole career.”

Memphis lands Cam Boozar, historic international talent. No team may have left the draft happier than Memphis. The Grizzlies selected Duke star Cameron Boozar with the third overall pick, landing a player many scouts considered the

safest prospect in the class. Boozar arrives with a resume that includes National Player of the Year honors and statistical company rarely seen in college basketball. He became the first freshman or sophomore to average at least 20 points, 10 rebounds and four assists in a season since Larry Bird nearly 50 years ago. But Memphis wasn’t finished.

Later in the round, the Grizzlies acquired the draft rights to Karim Lopez, creating one of the night’s biggest storylines.

The Mexican forward became the first Mexican-born player ever selected in the first round of an NBA Draft. Before Lopez, former Dallas Mavericks forward Eduardo Najera’s No. 38 selection in 2000 was the highest for a Mexican-born player.

“It’s great,” Lopez said. “It’s another one to the list. Basketball is a great sport. It’s going to keep growing.”

For basketball fans across Latin America, Lopez’s selection represented a landmark moment.

The Hermosillo native starred in Australia’s NBL Next Stars program, where he broke scoring records previously held by future NBA lottery picks such as LaMelo Ball and Josh Giddey.

His rise may also resonate with Filipino basketball fans.

Filipino center Kai Sotto previously played in the same NBL Next Stars pathway before going undrafted in 2022. Sotto continues to pursue his NBA dream and is reportedly planning to participate in NBA Summer League opportunities this year. Lopez’s breakthrough serves as another example of the growing influence of the Australian-based development program on the NBA’s international talent pipeline. Now, Lopez joins Boozar as part of a Memphis youth movement that could shape the Western Conference for years.

Brooklyn, New York head opposite directions. The contrast between New York’s two NBA franchises could not have been sharper.

The Brooklyn Nets continued their rebuilding project by selecting Louisville guard Mikel Brown Jr.

with the sixth overall pick. Brown became Louisville’s highest-drafted player in 36 years and immediately embraced the challenge of helping restore the franchise.

“We are going to try to bring a chip,” Brown said after joining a roster that recently added veteran stars Julius Randle and Michael Porter Jr.

Across the East River, the defending champion Knicks spent the night doing something contenders rarely do: trading out.

New York entered the draft with the No. 24 pick but ultimately maneuvered completely out of the first round through a series of deals involving Cameron Carr, Sergio de Larrea and Koa Peat.

The Knicks turned their first-round assets into multiple future second-round picks and cash considerations, a move widely viewed as part of their effort to maintain financial flexibility while keeping together a championship roster under the NBA’s increasingly restrictive salary-cap rules.

For Brooklyn, the draft was about building the future.

For New York, it was about protecting the present.

NBA’s future more global than ever

The night also highlighted the league’s international growth.

Spain produced two first-round selections. Germany added another lottery addition. Mexico celebrated its first-ever first-round pick. International players once again occupied prominent spots throughout the draft.

Meanwhile, the opening eight selections were all college freshmen, tying the record set just a year earlier and underscoring the league’s growing appetite for youth and upside.

In a draft filled with twists, records and international milestones, one thing became clear: The NBA’s future is getting younger, more global and more unpredictable than ever.



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